

Generative AI Acceptable Use & Data Protection Policy

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to define the security boundaries for using Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) tools (such as ChatGPT, Claude, and Microsoft Copilot) at Apex Solutions. This policy ensures that employees can use AI to increase productivity while strictly protecting company data privacy, client confidentiality, and intellectual property.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time employees, part-time workers, interns, contractors, and third-party vendors operating company-owned devices or accessing corporate networks.

3. Data Classification & Access Controls

To protect sensitive data from being leaked to public AI models (which use inputs for public training), the company establishes a traffic-light data control system:

Red Light: Strictly Prohibited Data

Employees **MUST NEVER** paste, upload, or feed the following data into public, free-tier AI tools:

- Personally Identifiable Information (PII) like customer names, emails, or phone numbers.
- Financial data, credit card numbers, or bank details.
- Corporate source code, encryption keys, or system passwords.
- Proprietary business strategies or unreleased product plans.

Green Light: Allowed Data

Employees are **PERMITTED** to use public AI tools for generic business tasks using non-sensitive data, including:

- Writing or polishing generic business emails.
- Brainstorming marketing copy or social media ideas.
- Summarizing public articles, news, or open-source research.
- Generating blank document templates.

4. Risk Mitigation & Governance Controls

To address specific threats introduced by Artificial Intelligence, the following organizational security controls are mandated:

- **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL) Requirement:** AI models are prone to "hallucinations" (generating convincing but false data). No AI-generated content may be sent to clients or used in official reports without direct review and verification by a human employee.
- **Shadow AI Mitigation:** Employees are prohibited from installing unapproved AI browser extensions or third-party plugins. The IT Security team will perform regular network audits to discover and block unauthorized AI tools.

5. Compliance & Enforcement

Compliance with this policy is mandatory. Violations, including the unauthorized exposure of critical corporate assets to public LLM endpoints, will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.
